SENATE PROCLAMATION NO. 5

WHEREAS, The Senate of the State of Texas is pleased to recognize Dr. Bruce Gearing, who is retiring as superintendent of the Leander Independent School District and concluding nearly three decades of outstanding service in public education; and

WHEREAS, A native of South Africa, Bruce Gearing started his career as a high school math and science teacher and taught internationally for three years; since then, he has made a positive impact in the lives of students in Texarkana, Mount Pleasant, Marshall, Dripping Springs, and beyond through his contributions as a teacher and principal and as superintendent of schools for Leander Independent School District; and

WHEREAS, Since assuming the role of superintendent in 2019, Dr. Gearing has guided the Leander Independent School District with distinction; under his leadership, the district created a five-year strategic plan to increase student engagement in comprehensive learning, and in 2024, it was named the College Board Advanced Placement Large District of the Year for increased participation and improved test scores; and

WHEREAS, A devoted educator with more than 30 years of experience, Dr. Gearing has embraced his role as superintendent with tenacity and heart; among his many accolades, he was named Region 13 Superintendent of the Year and a Texas Superintendent of the Year finalist; he served as president of the Fast Growth School Coalition, and he was called to testify as a key voice in legislative discussions on school finance and credit transferability; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Gearing has built a culture of excellence rooted in academic achievement, strong community ties, and belief in the transformative power of public education; through his purposeful leadership, he has empowered students to reach their full potential and created invaluable opportunities for young Texans, and it is indeed fitting that he receive special recognition for his exemplary efforts; now, therefore, be it

PROCLAIMED, That the Senate of the State of Texas hereby commend Dr. Bruce Gearing on his outstanding leadership and contributions as superintendent of the Leander Independent School District and extend to him congratulations on his retirement and best wishes for the future; and, be it further

PROCLAIMED, That a copy of this Proclamation be prepared for him as an expression of esteem from the Texas Senate.

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Member, Texas Senate

I hereby certify that the above Proclamation was adopted.

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Secretary of the Senate